



# August 27th 2019 Delaware County Council Meeting

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YNCDG3HPU8g">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YNCDG3HPU8g</a> |
| Publication Date | 2019-08-28T17:25:06Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | delaware_county                                                                                       |

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## County Council Meeting Summary Report

### 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:00:12](#) The County Council meeting was called to order by the presiding officer, welcoming participants.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Members Present:** Alexander, Fowler, Bledsoe, Chambers, Lassiter, Piper, Hughes (and Ballard noted in later roll calls).
  - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in the opening transcript, but leading the proceedings.

### 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening roll call and posting of the agenda.
- **Approval of Minutes:** [00:01:57](#) The minutes of the July 22 meeting were approved following a motion, second, and roll call vote.

### 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:02:45](#) County Clerk Presentation: Electronic Poll Books

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Clerk and Mike Miller (President and co-owner of MicroVote Company / Poll Pad).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation on the implementation of electronic poll books ("Poll Pads" using iPad hardware) across Indiana counties, detailing check-in speed, driver's license scanning, signature capture, and ballot activation.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal board vote taken at this time.
- **00:01:59 County General Prosecutor: Investigator Grant Request**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor's Office.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$1,249.95 for an investigator grant (100% grant-funded personnel).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by roll call vote.
- **00:01:54 Plan Commission: Building Commissioner Position Adjustment**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Plan Commission (Marna).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion on converting a part-time building commissioner position to full-time to handle commercial building permits and state inspections. An amendment was introduced to reduce the immediate appropriation request to \$2,898.42 to account for remaining part-time funds and the timeline for hiring.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved as amended by roll call vote.
- **00:31:40 Commissioners: Institutional Care / Community Corrections Transfer**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Community Corrections (Jane Miranda).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$200,000 for institutional care / jail release programs to help manage inmate populations and reduce out-of-county housing costs. Funds were discussed for transfer from health insurance appropriations.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:46:04 EMS Department Budget Requests**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMS Department.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Requests totaling \$80,350 covering gasoline (\$40,350), utilities (\$18,000), and computers/printing (\$22,649).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:48:16 Street Department: Striping Contract**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Street Department.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$142,580 for a contractor striping agreement covering road lines.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **01:11:45 Coroner Office Salary & Operations Ordinance (Ordinance 2019-01)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Coroner's Office.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction and approval of an ordinance addressing deputy coroner call pay and monthly payroll structures as recommended by the State Board of Accounts.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced and Approved by roll call vote (Ordinance 2019-01).
- **01:19:25 Vote Center Resolution (Resolution 2019-028)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Clerk / Election Board.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Consideration of a resolution moving Delaware County toward becoming a Vote Center County, requiring joint approval from the County Council and Commissioners before proceeding to the state and election board.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Resolution 2019-028).
- **01:21:44 Communications Center (911): Federal Grant & Equipment Upgrade Presentation**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Communications Center Director / Barry Ritter (RSS).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Informational presentation regarding a federal reimbursement grant and a total project cost of \$1,395,000 to overhaul 911 dispatch, phone systems, and mobile backup equipment. Discussed local match requirements, state fee reimbursements, and impending expiration of the city-county interlocal agreement.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no immediate appropriation vote taken.
- **01:48:40 Tax Caps & Maximum Levies Review (2020)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor / Council.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of estimated 2020 property tax caps and maximum levies following corrections from state workshops, noting reduced projected tax cap losses for County General.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved moving forward with no recommendations for changes to maximum levies (consistent with prior years).
- *Note: Numerous routine departmental salary transfers, line-item adjustments, and "crumbs" clean-up appropriations for various county offices (Circuit Court, Prosecutor, Sheriff, EMA, Communications, Recorder, etc.) were processed via roll call votes throughout the meeting.*

## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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- **01:16:11 Margaret Fink & Mr. Beale (Muncie 90 Tea Party):** Appeared as facilitators for the Muncie Tea Party to distribute copies of the United States Constitution in honor of Constitution Day (September 17th) and referenced Benjamin Franklin's historic quote regarding keeping a republic.
- **01:31:34 Barry Ritter (RSS / Consultant):** Spoke during the Communications Center discussion regarding federal grant reimbursement timelines (approx. 90 days) and long-term lease cost-prohibitions.

## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - Extension Office updates provided regarding 4-H programs and State Fair participation.
  - Mention of the presiding officer returning from a medical injury/brace.
- **Adjournment:** 02:02:51 Motion to adjourn made and approved by voice vote / general consensus.

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